

BREATH WEAPONS DAMAGE: All dragons have a special attack with their "Breath Weapon" in addition to their claw and bite attacks. Any dragon can use its Breath Weapon up to 3 times each day. A dragon's first attack is always with its Breath Weapon. **The number of points of damage any Breath Weapon does is equal to the dragon's remaining number of hit points.** Any damage done to a dragon will reduce the damage it can do with its Breath Weapon.

After the first Breath attack, a dragon may choose to attack with claws and bite. To determine this randomly, roll 1d6:

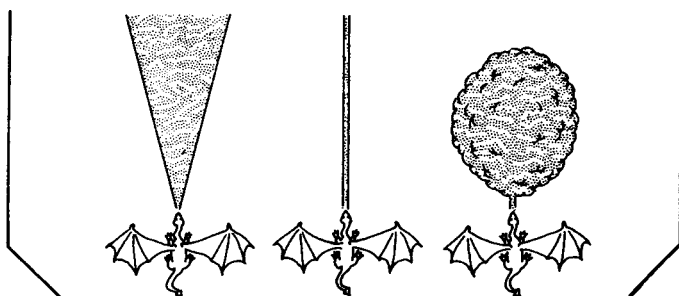
- a result of 1-3 means that the dragon will use its claw and bite attacks;
- a result of 4-6 means that the dragon will breathe again.

SHAPE OF BREATH: A dragon's Breath Weapon appears as one of three different shapes: **cone-shaped**, a **straight line**, or a **cloud of gas**.

A **cone-shaped** Breath begins at the dragon's mouth (where it is 2' wide) and spreads out until it is 30' wide at its furthest end. **EXAMPLE:** The area of effect of a white dragon's Breath is a cone 80' long and 30' wide at its far end.

A **line-shaped** Breath starts in the dragon's mouth and stretches out towards its victim in a straight line (even downwards). Even at its source, a line-shaped Breath is 5' wide.

A **cloud-shaped** Breath billows forth from the dragon's mouth to form a 50'x40'x20' tall cloud around the dragon's targets directly in front of it.



SAVING THROWS: Anyone caught within the area of effect of a dragon's Breath Weapon may make a saving throw. A successful saving throw means that the victim takes only 1/2 damage from the Breath. Dragons are never affected by the normal or smaller versions of their Breath Weapons, and automatically make their saving throws against any attack form which is the same as their Breath Weapon. **EXAMPLE:** A red dragon will take no damage from (and usually ignores) burning oil, and will always take only 1/2 damage from a fire-type magic spell, such as a **fire ball**.

TALKING: Dragons are intelligent, and some dragons can speak Dragon and Common. The percentage listed under **Chance of Talking** is the chance that a dragon will be able to talk. Talking dragons are also able to use Magic-user/Elf spells. The number of spells and their levels are given above, under **Spells (by Level)**. For example, 3 3 — would mean that the dragon can cast 3 first level spells and 3 second level spells, but no third level spells. Dragon spells are usually selected randomly.

SLEEPING DRAGONS: The percentage chance given under **Chance of Being Asleep** applies whenever a party encounters a dragon on the ground (flying dragons are never asleep). Any result greater than the percentage means that the dragon is *not* asleep (though it may be pretending to be!). If a dragon is asleep, it may be attacked (with a bonus of +2 on "to hit" rolls) for one round,

during which it will wake. Combat will proceed normally for the second and further rounds.

SUBDUING DRAGONS: Whenever characters encounter a dragon, they may choose to try to subdue it rather than kill it. To subdue a dragon, all the attacks *must* be with "the flat of the sword"; thus, missile weapons and spells may not be used to subdue. Attacks and damage are determined normally when trying to subdue the dragon. The dragon will fight normally (the subduing damage does not reduce the damage done by the dragon's Breath Weapon) until it reaches 0 or less hit points, at which time it will surrender. A dragon, like any other intelligent animal or monster, may be subdued because it realizes that its attackers, *could* have killed it if they had been striking to kill. It therefore surrenders, admitting that the opponents have won the battle but saving its own life.

A subdued dragon will attempt to escape or turn on its captor if given a reasonable chance to do so through the party's actions. For example, a dragon left unguarded at night, or who is ordered to guard a position alone, would consider these "reasonable chances". A subdued dragon must be sold. The price is up to the DM, but should never exceed 1,000 gp per hit point. The dragon may be forced to serve the characters who subdued it. If a subdued dragon is ever ordered to perform a task which is apparently suicidal, the dragon will attempt to escape and/or kill its captors.

AGE: The statistics given are for an average-sized dragon of its type. Younger dragons are smaller and have acquired less treasure; older dragons are larger and have acquired more. Dragons generally range in size from 3 hit dice smaller to 3 hit dice larger than average. For example, red dragons could be found having 7 to 13 hit dice, depending on their age.

TREASURE: Younger dragons may have collected as little as 1/4 to 1/2 the normal listed treasure; older dragons may have as much as double the listed amount. Dragon treasure is only found in the dragon's lair. These lairs are rarely left unguarded, and are well-hidden to prevent easy discovery.

GOLD DRAGONS: Gold dragons always talk and use spells. They can also change their shape, and often appear in the form of a human or animal. Gold dragons may breathe either fire (like a red dragon) or chlorine gas (like a green dragon), though they still have a total of 3 Breath Weapon attacks per day (*not* 6). The type of Breath attack should be chosen by the DM to fit the situation.

Dragons are extremely powerful monsters and should be used with caution when encountered by low level player characters (such as those found in the D&D BASIC rules). It is recommended that until characters reach the fourth and higher levels of experience (see the D&D EXPERT rules) that only the *youngest* and smallest dragons be used by the DM.

Driver Ant

Armor Class:	3	No. Appearing:	2-8 (4-24)
Hit Dice:	4*	Save As:	Fighter: 2
Move:	180' (60')	Morale:	7 and see below
Attacks:	1	Treasure Type:	U or see below
Damage:	2-12	Alignment:	Neutral

Driver ants are giant black ants about 6' long. They are omnivorous. When hungry, they will devour anything edible in their path. Once engaged in combat, they will fight to the death, even trying to cross flames to reach their opponents. The nest-lair will always be guarded by 4-24 driver ants. There are legends of driver ants mining gold, and there is a 30% chance that a driver ant lair will contain 1-10 thousand gp worth of nuggets.